Adam Brzezinski

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EMPLOYMENT

London School of Economics and Political Science, STICERD *since 10/2023*

British Academy Postdoctoral Fellow

EDUCATION

University of Oxford, New College *2018–2023*

DPhil (PhD) in Economics

Dissertation: *Essays in Political Economy* (Advisor: Rick van der Ploeg)

University of Oxford, St. Peter's College *2016–2018*

MPhil in Economics (Distinction)

University of Warwick *2013–2016*

BSc in Economics (First Class)

FIELDS

Primary field	Political Economy
Secondary fields	Theory; Economic History; Monetary Economics; Text-as-Data

REFERENCES

Tim Besley
London School of Economics and Political Science
t.besley@lse.ac.uk

Luis Garicano
London School of Economics and Political Science
l.garicano@lse.ac.uk

Rick van der Ploeg
University of Oxford
rick.vanderploeg@economics.ox.ac.uk

Stephane Wolton
London School of Economics and Political Science
s.wolton@lse.ac.uk

JOB MARKET PAPER

Narratives of Blame

Narratives of blame explain the disappointments of some people through the undeserved advantages of others. I develop a model in which a left and a right party use such narratives to mobilize their supporters by suggesting that they deserve better. I distinguish conditions favoring the right in mobilising with blame from those favoring the left, and show how incentives to leverage blame distort policy choices. For measurement, I develop two AI-based methods to analyse 1.4 million US congressional speeches from 1945 to 2026 and identify whom speakers blame, whom they portray as victims, and what type of harm they concentrate on. I find that Republicans and Democrats began shifting toward non-economic forms of blame as early as the 1980s. This shift coincides with declining salience of economic issues and growing Republican support among culturally aggrieved and less educated voters. Viewed through the model, these developments suggest that Republicans have become increasingly effective at mobilizing with blame relative to Democrats over several decades.

WORKING PAPERS AND WORK IN PROGRESS

Deliberative Democracy in Political Equilibrium

with Tim Besley

Revise and Resubmit, American Political Science Review

Money for Taxes
with Roberto Bonfatti, K. Kivanc Karaman and Nuno Palma
Accepted, International Economic Review

Narrative Entanglement
with Luis Garicano
CEPR Discussion Paper DP20829.
Covered in the Climate Economics podcast and the Cities 1.5 podcast.

A Dynamic Model of Political Narratives and the Rise of Neoliberalism
with Tim Besley
CEPR Discussion Paper DP20410.

Narratives and the Size of Government
with Tim Besley and Jake Fazzio

PUBLICATIONS

Economic Policy Narratives: A Taxonomy and Application
with Tim Besley and Jake Fazzio
LSE Public Policy Review, 4(1), p. 4. 2026.

The Vagaries of the Sea: Evidence on the Real Effects of Money from Maritime Disasters in the Spanish Empire
with Yao Chen, Nuno Palma and Felix Ward
Review of Economics and Statistics, 106(5), 1220–1235. 2024.

Understanding Money using Historical Evidence
with Nuno Palma and François Velde
Annual Review of Economics, 16, 571–595. 2024.
Covered in The Economist, September 2024.

Science Skepticism Reduced Compliance with COVID-19 Shelter-in-Place Policies in the United States
with Valentin Kecht, David Van Dijcke and Austin Wright
Nature Human Behaviour. 2021.

The COVID-19 Pandemic: Government vs. Community Action Across the United States
with Guido Deiana, Valentin Kecht and David Van Dijcke
Covid Economics: Vetted and Real-Time Papers, 7, 115–156. 2020.

Synergies in Labour Market Institutions: The Nonlinear Effect of Minimum Wages on Youth Employment
Atlantic Economic Journal, 45(2), 251–263. 2017.
Undergraduate thesis; published as part of the international Best Undergraduate Paper Award

POLICY PAPERS

A New UK Overlapping Generations Model
with Arno Hantzsche and James Watson
OBR Working Paper No. 22. 2025.
Used in the OBR's Fiscal Risks and Sustainability Report, July 2025.

AWARDS, GRANTS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

British Academy Postdoctoral Fellowship (£366,000)	*2023–2026*
STICERD Research Grant (£4,465)	*2026*
Rhine Group Fellowship	*2026*
David Walton Distinguished Scholarship, University of Oxford (£15,000)	*2022–2023*

Austrian Marshall Plan Foundation Fellowship ($6,500) *2022–2023*

Best Paper Award of WU/City of Vienna (€3,500) *2022*

Carnevali Small Research Grant, Economic History Society (£3,500) *2020*

1379 Old Members Scholarship, New College, Oxford (£5,000 p.a., 3 years) *2018–2021*

Doctoral Bursary, Oxford Department of Economics *2018–2021*

Best Undergraduate Paper Award, International Atlantic Economic Society *2016*

PRESENTATIONS

Upcoming Political Economy Seminar, LSE; European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society, Warsaw; ASSA 2027, Washington, D.C.; Behavioural Political Economy Workshop, LSE

2026 PSPE Work in Progress Seminar, LSE; AI in Social Science Conference, Chicago; IOG Fall Conference, Chicago (joint presentation with Tim Besley); APSA 2026, Boston; EEA-ESEM Conference, Dublin; NBER Summer Institute, Cambridge; Text-as-Data Conference, Bath; SIOE Conference, INSEAD; ERINN Conference, University of Namur; C40 Centre Talk, London; Public Policy Review, LSE; Narratives in Policymaking, LSE (panel discussion); North American Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society, Philadelphia

2025 European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society, Nicosia; Research Seminar, Humboldt University Berlin; SIOE Conference, Sydney; WEHC, Lund; Narratives and Culture in Historical Perspective, LSE; IBEO Political Economy workshop, Alghero; Public Policy Review, LSE (2x); Deliberation and Cohesion Seminar, LSE (2x); PSPE Seminar, LSE; Choice Research Centre Seminar, University of Leicester; Behavioural Political Economy Workshop, LSE (as discussant); Economics Group seminar, King's College London

2024 PSPE Symposium, LSE; Classical Liberalism Symposium, LSE; 8th MWZ CEPR Text-as-Data Workshop; NICEP Political Economy Seminar, University of Nottingham

2023 HM Treasury OLG Workshop, London; IES Workshop, UC Berkeley

2022 Lindau Meeting on Economic Sciences, Lindau; WEHC Conference, Paris; EHES Conference, University of Groningen; Quantitative Methods in Economics seminar, University of Michigan; ASSA Econometric Society Lightning Round for PhD Students; Political Science and Political Economy Work in Progress Seminar, LSE; Micro Theory Student Workshop, University of Oxford

2021 Macrohistory Workshop, University of Bonn; Monetary Policy Conference, University of Manchester; Micro Theory Student Workshop, University of Oxford; Socioeconomics Seminar, Vienna University of Economics and Business; Economic History Society Annual Conference, University of Warwick

2020 Economic & Social History Graduate Seminar, University of Oxford; Micro Theory Student Workshop, University of Oxford; European History Association Conference (as discussant)

2019 Research Seminar, Humboldt University Berlin; CFP Wellbeing Workshop, University of Utrecht; European Historical Economics Society Conference, Paris School of Economics; Financial history workshop, Goethe University Frankfurt; Lunchtime Seminar, University of Manchester

2016 Best Undergraduate Paper Competition (IAES), Washington, D.C.

TEACHING

University College, University of Oxford *2018–2023*

Graduate Teaching Assistant (2018–2020); Stipendiary Lecturer (2020–2023)

Elementary Mathematical Methods (undergraduate) *2018–2022*

Microeconomics Prelims (undergraduate) *2018–2023*

Macroeconomics Prelims (undergraduate) *2020*

Core Microeconomics (undergraduate) *2018–2023*

Opportunity Oxford Programme for incoming PPE students *2022–2023*

Designed and taught the course

WU Vienna *2022–2023*

Research and Teaching Associate, Department of Socioeconomics

Global Trends in Populism and Social Inequality (undergraduate) *2022–2023*

Designed the course

London School of Economics and Political Science *2023–2024*

Teaching Fellow, Department of Economics

Political Economy (EC453, graduate) *2023–2024*

Guest Lecturer, School of Public Policy

Strategic Policymaking (PP425, graduate) *2023–2024*

Co-designed the course with Luis Garicano

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Refereeing	American Journal of Political Science (x2); Review of Economics and Statistics; Economica (x4); Journal of Law, Economics and Organization; European Economic Review; Journal of Institutional and Theoretical Economics; Explorations in Economic History; European Review of Economic History; Empirical Economics; Economics Letters
Conference organization	"Narratives and Culture in Historical Perspective", LSE, June 20–21, 2025
Programme leadership	Co-leader of the Young Scholars Programme of the Huth Initiative for a New Political Economy, LSE (selecting scholars and organizing their seminars)
Grant refereeing	ERC Advanced Grant; LSE Cohesive Capitalism Programme Grants
Undergraduate admissions	PPE at Brasenose College, University of Oxford (two years)

RESEARCH VISITS

University of California, Berkeley *01/2023–05/2023*

Visiting PhD Student (Host: Barry Eichengreen)

LSE *01/2022–12/2022*

Visiting PhD Student (Host: Tim Besley)

OTHER EMPLOYMENT

HM Treasury *07/2023–09/2023*

Assistant Economist (also in 07/2022–09/2022)

Goldman Sachs, London *06/2015–08/2015*

Summer Intern, Equity Research

Received and declined a full-time job offer

PERSONAL

Citizenship	Austrian (with UK Settled Status)
Languages	English (fluent); German (native); Polish (native); Russian (intermediate); Spanish (intermediate); French (beginner)